



Menstrual Health | Gender Equality | Community-led Change

Gadchiroli | Raigad | Pune

22 Districts | 60 Facilitators | 4,000+ Sessions



samajbandhindia@gmail.com



+91 7709488286



linktr.ee/samajbandh

Periods Shouldn't Limit a Woman's Life



TABOO

Myths, restrictions and social stigma continue to shape how girls and women experience menstruation.

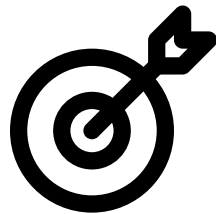
INEQUALITY

In some tribal communities, women still have to live separately during menstruation.

HEALTH

Lack of scientific information and safe menstrual practices increase health risks.

Samajbandh's Mission:



Create a society where menstruation is understood as a natural process and every menstruator can maintain hygiene, access nutritious food, rest and live with dignity.



Kurma Gudse-Period Hut

**The problem isn't only access to a pad;
It is the social meaning attached to menstruation.**

Building Knowledge, Access & Mindset



Theory of Change: When communities gain accurate knowledge, access practical menstrual-health solutions and challenge discriminatory norms, menstruation becomes less restrictive, gaining menstruators greater dignity, health and freedom.

01 BUILD KNOWLEDGE Build understanding

- Age-appropriate menstrual-health education
- P for Period session
- Arogya Samwadak Fellowship for schools
- Repeated engagement through facilitators
- P for Period pocketbook

02 CREATE ACCESS Make healthy choices

- Asha Cloth Pad production
- 4 Production centres
- Reusable & affordable
- Repurposes old/reusable clothes
- Women trained to make their own pads

03 CHANGE NORMS Build local leadership

- Kurma Reform Program
- Building women grassroots leaders in villages
- Gotul discussions on norms
- Engagement with men and traditional leaders
- Change led from within communities

Knowledge → Confidence → Behavioural Change → Community Norms → Dignity

Visible Sustainable Change



Ranjana: From menstrual stigma to community leadership

25-year-old Ranjana from Hitapadi village became an Arogya Sakhi, challenged the Kurma tradition by choosing to stay in her own home yard, then progressed to becoming a field coordinator covering 35 villages and eventually became Vice Sarpanch.

- 10%** of women in the 49-villages of Bhamragad are now not staying in the period hut.
- 80%** of girls report a shift towards scientific understanding and more open conversations.
- 20K+** Women reached with Asha Pads, 90% report regular use



Ranjana conducting session in her village

The deepest impact is not a pad distributed or a session completed.

It's a woman becoming confident enough to challenge norm & lead others to do the same.

Proven, Scalable & Affordable Model



22 Districts > **60** Facilitators > **4,000+** Sessions > **150,000+** Menstruators

4 Asha Pad centres > **14** Shilai Sakhis > **1.3 L** Pads made/ distributed

3500 KG Clothes repurposed > **20,000** Women used Asha Cloth Pads

₹ ECONOMICS

₹55 - 3 sessions + book per Girl

₹240 - 6 Pad Kit per Menstruator

₹40 - Cost per Menstrual cycle

₹900 - Facilitator cost per Session



We have already moved from a founder-led model to a network-led model.

10 Years of Building Change From Within



Sachin Asha Subhash - Founder

Full-time social worker, built Samajbandh around menstrual health, gender equality and community-led change.



Sharvari Surekha Arun - Trustee

Full-time social worker, national trainer in menstrual health management and gender, and counsellor.

Core team: Prathmesh, Rutuja, Prajwal & Nivedita



Volunteers who grew into full-time team members. Post graduates rooted in villages with empathy and dedication.

Field team: of Facilitators, Arogya Sakhis, Shilai Sakhis and Volunteers.



Special episode by NDTV for Kurma eradication work

Recognised by: Goonj • Loksatta • Deepstambh • Pune Times Mirror • Lokmat